November 1 Lesson Plan: I Will Turn Their Mourning into Joy

Reading: Jeremiah 31–33; 36–39; Lamentations 1; 3 **Lesson emphasis:** Through Jesus Christ, the Lord restores covenant people, writes His law in their hearts, gives hope after sorrow, and invites them to return to Him.

Central question. How does Jesus Christ help us rebuild, return, and find hope when life feels broken or full of mourning?

Suggested focus

- The Lord loves and remembers His people.
- He makes covenants that change hearts.
- His word gives opportunities to repent and return.
- He asks us to be courageous in helping others.
- His mercies give hope even in grief.

25-Minute Lesson Flow

0:00–2:00 — Welcome and purpose. "Jeremiah taught people whose lives and nation were falling apart. Yet the Lord gave them promises of an everlasting covenant, a Savior who would come, and joy after mourning. Today, let's listen for what these scriptures teach about Jesus Christ's power to rebuild, forgive, and give hope."

2:00–5:00 — Quiet preparation. Invite students to write: (1) Which verse, image, or promise stayed with me? (2) What does it teach about Jesus Christ, covenants, scripture study, courage, or hope? (3) What is one thought another person should hear? Ask them to write the reference they plan to share.

5:00–15:00 — Student-led discussion. Invite students to share what they prepared. Ask: What do you notice about Heavenly Father or Jesus Christ? Which promise feels especially meaningful, and why? How could this truth help someone who feels distant from God, discouraged, or uncertain? If discussion slows, read Jeremiah 31:31–34 and use the Elder Walker passage.

15:00–21:00 — Choose one focused passage. Read one section on this handout and use one or two questions. Choose covenant change (Jeremiah 31 or 32), prayer and promises (Jeremiah 33), scripture power (Jeremiah 36), courage (Jeremiah 38), or hope after sorrow (Lamentations 3).

21:00–24:00 — Personal application. Invite students to choose one action: ask the Lord to write a principle more deeply in your heart; keep a covenant with greater purpose; study scripture with willingness to act; offer courageous help; or begin again by trusting in the Lord's new mercies. Ask: "What is one truth you want to carry into the coming week?"

24:00–25:00 — Conclusion. "The Lord's people had made painful mistakes and faced real sorrow, but He did not abandon them. Through Jesus Christ, He offers an everlasting covenant, forgiveness, compassion, and new mercies. As we seek Him and keep our covenants, He can write His law in our hearts and turn mourning into joy."

Teaching reminders

- Do not try to discuss every passage; choose the one that best serves the class.
- Let personal experiences remain voluntary.
- Affirm sincere comments without requiring polished answers.
- Keep pointing to Jesus Christ as the source of covenant power, forgiveness, courage, and hope.

Jeremiah 31:3, 13 — Everlasting love and joy after mourning

3 The Lord hath appeared of old unto me, saying, Yea, I have loved thee with an everlasting love: therefore with lovingkindness have I drawn thee.

13 Then shall the virgin rejoice in the dance, both young men and old together: for I will turn their mourning into joy, and will comfort them, and make them rejoice from their sorrow.

What it teaches The Lord's love is lasting. He does not ignore sorrow, but He promises comfort and joy through Jesus Christ.

Questions

- *What is different about an "everlasting love" from ordinary love or approval?*
- *How have you seen the Lord use lovingkindness to draw people toward Him?*
- *What does it mean to trust that Christ can turn mourning into joy, even when sorrow does not disappear immediately?*

Jeremiah 31:31–34 — The covenant written in our hearts

31 Behold, the days come, saith the Lord, that I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel, and with the house of Judah:

32 Not according to the covenant that I made with their fathers in the day that I took them by the hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt; which my covenant they brake, although I was an husband unto them, saith the Lord:

33 But this shall be the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel; After those days, saith the Lord, I will put my law in their inward parts, and write it in their hearts; and will be their God, and they shall be my people.

34 And they shall teach no more every man his neighbour, and every man his brother, saying, Know the Lord: for they shall all know me, from the least of them unto the greatest of them, saith the Lord: for I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more.

What it teaches The Savior wants to change our desires, help us know Him personally, and forgive us.

Questions

- *What might it look like for God's law to be written in our hearts, not just in our notes or on a list?*
- *Which covenant practices help the Savior change us from within?*
- *How does the promise of forgiveness help us keep trying after mistakes?*

Elder Alan R. Walker: "A Peculiar Treasure"

"The Lord declared that His people would be a peculiar treasure unto Him if they would obey His voice and keep His covenant."

"Peculiar treasure" means special and personal to God. Covenant keeping is more than a checklist; it is a relationship in which we belong to God and receive the Savior's strength, guidance, and help.

Questions

- *How does viewing ourselves as God's treasured people change how we view covenant keeping?*
- *What everyday covenant practice helps God's law become more deeply written in your heart?*
- *How can we remember that covenants are a connection to Christ, not proof that we are already perfect?*

Talk: "A Peculiar Treasure," Elder Alan R. Walker, April 2026.

Jeremiah 32:37–42 — Gathered by an everlasting covenant

37 Behold, I will gather them out of all countries, whither I have driven them in mine anger, and in my fury, and in great wrath; and I will bring them again unto this place, and I will cause them to dwell safely:

38 And they shall be my people, and I will be their God:

39 And I will give them one heart, and one way, that they may fear me for ever, for the good of them, and of their children after them:

40 And I will make an everlasting covenant with them, that I will not turn away from them, to do them good; but I will put my fear in their hearts, that they shall not depart from me.

41 Yea, I will rejoice over them to do them good, and I will plant them in this land assuredly with my whole heart and with my whole soul.

42 For thus saith the Lord; Like as I have brought all this great evil upon this people, so will I bring upon them all the good that I have promised them.

What it teaches The Lord gathers His people, gives them one heart and one way, and rejoices to do them good.

Questions

- *What promises from these verses feel especially personal or hopeful?*
- *What might "one heart, and one way" look like in a family, quorum, class, or ward?*
- *How can the Lord's desire to "do [us] good" change the way we respond to His commandments?*

Jeremiah 33:3, 14–16 — The promised Messiah rebuilds and saves

3 Call unto me, and I will answer thee, and shew thee great and mighty things, which thou knowest not.

14 Behold, the days come, saith the Lord, that I will perform that good thing which I have promised unto the house of Israel and to the house of Judah.

15 In those days, and at that time, will I cause the Branch of righteousness to grow up unto David; and he shall execute judgment and righteousness in the land.

16 In those days shall Judah be saved, and Jerusalem shall dwell safely: and this is the name wherewith she shall be called, The Lord our righteousness.

What it teaches Jesus Christ is the "Branch of righteousness." He keeps God's promises, saves, and brings righteousness where there has been ruin.

Questions

- *What does "Call unto me, and I will answer thee" invite us to do when we are uncertain or discouraged?*
- *How does identifying Jesus Christ as the "Branch of righteousness" affect the way we read these promises?*
- *What helps us trust that the Lord will fulfill His good promises in His time?*

Jeremiah 36:2–3 — The scriptures invite us to return

2 Take thee a roll of a book, and write therein all the words that I have spoken unto thee against Israel, and against Judah, and against all the nations, from the day I spake unto thee, from the days of Josiah, even unto this day.

3 It may be that the house of Judah will hear all the evil which I purpose to do unto them; that they may return every man from his evil way; that I may forgive their iniquity and their sin.

What it teaches The Lord had Jeremiah preserve His words so people could hear, turn from evil, and be forgiven.

Questions

- *What do these verses teach about why God gives us scriptures?*
- *When has a scripture helped you see a needed change, receive comfort, or draw closer to Christ?*
- *What is the difference between responding humbly to God's word and resisting it?*

Jeremiah 38:6–13 — Courage to stand up for what is right

6 Then took they Jeremiah, and cast him into the dungeon of Malchiah the son of Hammelech, that was in the court of the prison: and they let down Jeremiah with cords. And in the dungeon there was no water, but mire: so Jeremiah sunk in the mire.

7 Now when Ebed-melech the Ethiopian, one of the eunuchs which was in the king's house, heard that they had put Jeremiah in the dungeon; the king then sitting in the gate of Benjamin;

8 Ebed-melech went forth out of the king's house, and spake to the king, saying,

9 My lord the king, these men have done evil in all that they have done to Jeremiah the prophet, whom they have cast into the dungeon; and he is like to die for hunger in the place where he is: for there is no more bread in the city.

10 Then the king commanded Ebed-melech the Ethiopian, saying, Take from hence thirty men with thee, and take up Jeremiah the prophet out of the dungeon, before he die.

11 So Ebed-melech took the men with him, and went into the house of the king under the treasury, and took thence old cast clouts and old rotten rags, and let them down by cords into the dungeon to Jeremiah.

12 And Ebed-melech the Ethiopian said unto Jeremiah, Put now these old cast clouts and rotten rags under thine armholes under the cords. And Jeremiah did so.

13 So they drew up Jeremiah with cords, and took him up out of the dungeon: and Jeremiah remained in the court of the prison.

What it teaches Ebed-melech showed moral courage and practical compassion. He spoke up, acted, and protected the Lord's prophet.

Questions

- *What details in Ebed-melech's actions show both courage and compassion?*
- *When might we need to speak up or act to help someone who is being harmed, isolated, or treated unfairly?*
- *What does it look like to stand up for what is right with both boldness and kindness?*

Lamentations 3:21–26, 31–33 — New mercies and enduring hope

21 This I recall to my mind, therefore have I hope.

22 It is of the Lord's mercies that we are not consumed, because his compassions fail not.

23 They are new every morning: great is thy faithfulness.

24 The Lord is my portion, saith my soul; therefore will I hope in him.

25 The Lord is good unto them that wait for him, to the soul that seeketh him.

26 It is good that a man should both hope and quietly wait for the salvation of the Lord.

31 For the Lord will not cast off for ever:

32 But though he cause grief, yet will he have compassion according to the multitude of his mercies.

33 For he doth not afflict willingly nor grieve the children of men.

What it teaches Hope in Jesus Christ can coexist with real sorrow. His compassion does not fail, His mercies are renewed each day, and He does not cast us off forever.

Questions

- *Which phrase gives you the most hope? Why?*
- *What might "new every morning" look like for someone trying to repent, heal, or begin again?*
- *How can we patiently seek the Lord without pretending that grief is not real?*

Optional video: "Painted into a Corner" (3:41)

Use with Lamentations 3:21–26, 31–33. Listen for what you notice about Jesus Christ's willingness to help someone who feels they have run out of good options.

Discuss after the video

- *What feelings or circumstances can make a person feel "painted into a corner"?*
- *Which phrase from Lamentations 3:21–26 would you share with someone who feels hopeless?*
- *How does the Savior offer help without minimizing sin, consequences, or sorrow?*
- *What does it mean that the Lord's mercies are "new every morning" in a real situation?*
- *What is one faithful next step a person can take when they want to come back to the Lord?*

Teaching note. Keep the discussion focused on hope and the Savior's invitation to repent. Do not invite personal details about serious mistakes; experiences remain voluntary.

Video: ChurchofJesusChrist.org, "Painted into a Corner."